



Google-Inspired Anarchy

Here's an interview with a modern-day anarchist discussing her motivation in today's day and age <http://dgit.in/modanarchy>



Parent of Photokid

Here are some tips to get your child interested in photography. Put your child on the Geek path now! <http://dgit.in/photokid>

BUYING GUIDE

"Should I go for a TN or a VA panel? Should I stretch my budget and grab that elusive IPS? What about refresh rates? Is 60 enough? Oh! That 120Hz monitor looks tempting." If these are the kind of thoughts that race through your head when browsing for a monitor, fear not! Digit is here to help you out.

TN vs. VA: As you can see from the jargon buster, both are completely disparate display technologies and what they offer is also as disparate. VA panels offer great viewing angles and a very high contrast ratio, giving you images that are sharp and colours that are punchy at the same time. But they have a high response time, leading to some amount of blurring in fast-paced scenes. TN panels on the other hand offer poorer contrast and viewing angles, but can offer much better refresh rates.

That said, picking between the two is no easy feat. Most TN and VA panels sport similar refresh rates, which gives the edge to VA panels since they otherwise perform better. However, good quality TN panels, especially gaming panels, offer high refresh rates (120Hz+) and are definitely the right choice for movies and gaming. In the same vein, poor quality VA panels offer terrible contrast ratios and horrible refresh rates, negating the advantages of a VA panel.

Recommendations: If you want an ideal, all-purpose monitor at a reasonable price and size, go for the BenQ GL2460HM.

IPS: IPS panels are nice only if you want excellent colour reproduction and nothing else. The monitors are expensive, sport a lower contrast ratio when compared to most VA panels and offer the

lowest refresh rates. However, if you're a designer or photographer type person, someone who needs accurate colours, then you have no other choice but IPS.

Recommendation: The ASUS PA238Q if you're on a budget, otherwise just grab the ASUS PB278Q or NEC EA273WM-BK depending on the resolution you prefer. The NEC is a TN panel but it's well-calibrated and offers competitive colour reproduction.

Screen resolution: This is more of a personal choice. A higher screen resolution is usually better but as a rule of thumb, 1920x1080 is more than adequate for screens up to 24-inch in size. Monitors that are 27-inch and larger could do with a higher resolution (2560x1440) but the quality of the NEC EA273WM-BK proves that it's not a prerequisite. Do bear in mind that if you're a gamer, you might be better off sticking to a 1080p screen simply because a higher resolution will tax your system that much more – unless you've got a really powerful rig of course.

Refresh Rate: A high refresh rate is ideal for gaming and movies but that also means that you'll be restricted to TN panels. Most monitors in our test came with some sort of booster mode to boost refresh rates. However, from our tests we came to the conclusion that those modes don't really amount to much. A monitor that natively supports 120 Hz is preferable to one that "boosts" your refresh rate. As such, don't get swayed by the jargon. 60 Hz is acceptable, 120 Hz is better, but more expensive at the same time.

Recommendation: BenQ XL2411Z for its high refresh rate and excellent overall performance.

got with this monitor is exactly what one would expect from any high-quality IPS panel – great image quality, excellent colour reproduction, one of only two monitors to pass our sharpness test and a horrible refresh rate and low contrast ratio. This was also one of the more feature-rich monitors in the test and supports everything from DisplayPort (DP) to a USB hub. The monitor also lets you orient it any way you want with its flexible stand.

While the image quality is very good, it's important to note that there was a noticeable reddish tinge in the corners, especially when rendering dark scenes. This is a minor drawback though and a small price to pay for image quality. If you're in the market for a professional monitor that will give you great colour reproduction, look no further than this one.

ASUS VS238H

This uses a 24-inch TN panel and as impressive as the PA238Q was, this is as disappointing. The monitor is just about average in every department except the price, where it's among the more expensive options available. It's also light on features and connectivity options, but what's most disappointing is the refresh rate, which seemed to be quite bad in our real-world tests. One could argue that the monitor is more suited for office work, but even then there are better monitors available.

BenQ GL2250HM

This is a bare-bones monitor and the cheapest one in our test, but it's also one of the most disappointing and the price is no excuse for the abysmal performance. The brightness,

Viewsonic VX2452mh

The only offering from Viewsonic was mildly disappointing. It's a TN panel that boasts of a reasonably impressive contrast ratio, however, white levels are absolutely awful and so was the refresh rate. The monitor does give you the option of boosting refresh rate and while it does help to some extent, it doesn't do anything to mitigate the mildly washed out nature of the panel. Calibration with our sensor did help sort out the display quality somewhat, but we doubt that

most of you will have access to such a sensor in the first place, meaning you'll end up stuck with what you get out of the box. Considering its price and all the competitors in the segment, you can safely give this one a pass.

Acer S240HL

Another TN panel, the S240HL is a very light-weight panel with, unfortunately, the flimsiest stand in the test. You have the bare essential connectivity options and even though the monitor supports HDMI,

there's no audio I/O to be seen. The monitor's performance was just a smidgen ahead of the Viewsonic VX2452mh, mostly because of slightly better black levels and colour reproduction.

ASUS PA238Q

Easily the best 24-inch monitor in the test when you consider just the image quality, the PA238Q is also quite an expensive panel. It's an IPS panel that's been built for professionals who really care about their image quality. What we